

A red egret stands in shallow water, its long legs and neck visible. The bird is facing left, with its head turned slightly. The background is a clear blue sky. The water is calm, reflecting the bird and the sky.

Who I Used to Be

*For grieving who you were before
everything changed.*



I LIKE IT DEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL



Who I Used to Be

For grieving who you were before everything changed.

*"Write it. Feel it. Heal it.
Your journal knows the real you."*





BEFORE YOU BEGIN

A Note Before You Begin



Somewhere along the way, something changed you — an illness, a loss, a diagnosis, a breakup, becoming a parent, surviving something hard. And the person you were before that doesn't just disappear quietly. She's a real loss, even though she's still technically you. This journal is a place to grieve her properly, so you can stop pretending you should already be over missing her.





Who were you before everything changed? Describe her — how she moved through the world, what she believed.





What did she love doing that you haven't done in a long time?



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What did she believe about her future that didn't turn out the way she thought?





What made her laugh easily, back then?





What did she not know yet that you know now?





What's something about her you're actually proud of, looking back?





What's the moment, or the season, when you first felt her slipping away?





What's the first thing that felt different once she was gone?





What do you miss most about how it felt to be her?

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What do other people still expect from her that you can't give anymore?



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What does it feel like when someone says 'you've changed'?



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WHO I USED TO BE · PHOTO PAGES

This was the day _____

glue or tape a photo here

A little about this photo:





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Write her a letter. Tell her what happened, and what you'd want her to know now.





What's something you wish you could have told her before everything changed?





What's a piece of her you still carry, even now?





What would you want her to know about who you're becoming instead?





What's one thing that felt okay today, even a small thing?





What do you need permission to feel today — including missing a version of yourself?





What's one way you can honor her this week — something she loved, a small piece of her you bring back?





Write down one thing you know for sure about who you are now, even if everything else feels uncertain.





*She isn't gone. She's underneath who
you're becoming.
You're allowed to miss her and still keep
going.*

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